thedataguy16

SAVE FOR LATER

Data Analyst vs Product Analyst

Same SQL. Different questions.

10-PAGE PDF



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01 **Answers**

Data Analyst

- ✓ What happened in the business, and why?
- ✓ Sales fell in March: which region, which product

→ **Serves the whole business.**

VS

Product Analyst

- ✓ How do people use the app, and what should change?
- ✓ Where users drop off before paying

→ **Serves one product team.**

02

Same table, different question

Data Analyst

✓ Which region sold the most?

```
SELECT region, SUM(amount) FROM orders GROUP BY
region;
```

→ **Business result.**

VS

Product Analyst

✓ How many orders end up cancelled or returned?

```
SELECT status, COUNT(*) FROM orders GROUP BY
status;
```

→ **User behaviour.**

03 Daily tools

Data Analyst

- Excel, SQL
- Power BI or Tableau
- Some Python (pandas)

VS

Product Analyst

- SQL, a lot of it
- Event tools like Mixpanel or Amplitude
- Sheets, some Python

04

A normal day

Data Analyst

- Refresh the sales dashboard
- Answer a manager's quick question
- Clean a messy Excel export

VS

Product Analyst

- Check yesterday's sign-up funnel
- Size a feature idea with event data
- Read an A/B test with the product manager

05

Interviews ask

Data Analyst

- SQL joins and GROUP BY
- Lookups and pivots in Excel
- Walk me through your dashboard

VS

Product Analyst

- SQL on event tables
- How would you measure this feature?
- Read this A/B test result

06 Entry route for freshers

Data Analyst

- ✓ Excel + SQL + one BI tool
- ✓ 2-3 dashboard projects on sales or HR data

→ **Hired in almost every industry.**

VS

Product Analyst

- ✓ Strong SQL + product sense
- ✓ A funnel or retention project on app data

→ **Mostly product companies and startups.**

07

Pick it if you...

Data Analyst

- ✓ Like turning messy data into a clear report
- ✓ Want options in any industry, any city

→ **A good first analyst job.**

VS

Product Analyst

- ✓ Use apps and wonder why people quit them
- ✓ Enjoy experiments and arguing about metrics

→ **Easier after 1-2 years as an analyst.**

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